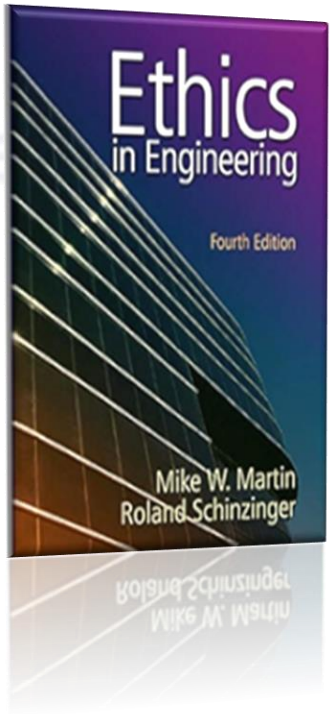
Engineering Ethics (HSS-422) (3+0)



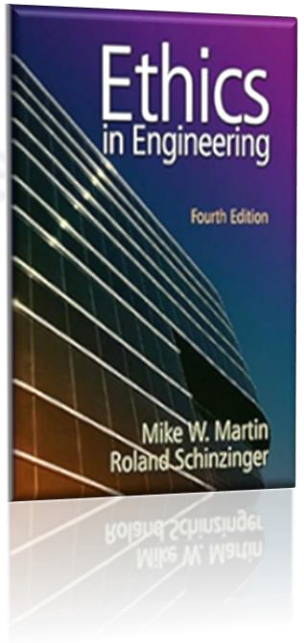




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Engineering Ethics (HSS-422) (3+0)

Department of Computer
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UNDERSTANDING ETHICAL PROBLEMS

Week No 10

By Engr. Syed Rizwan Ali

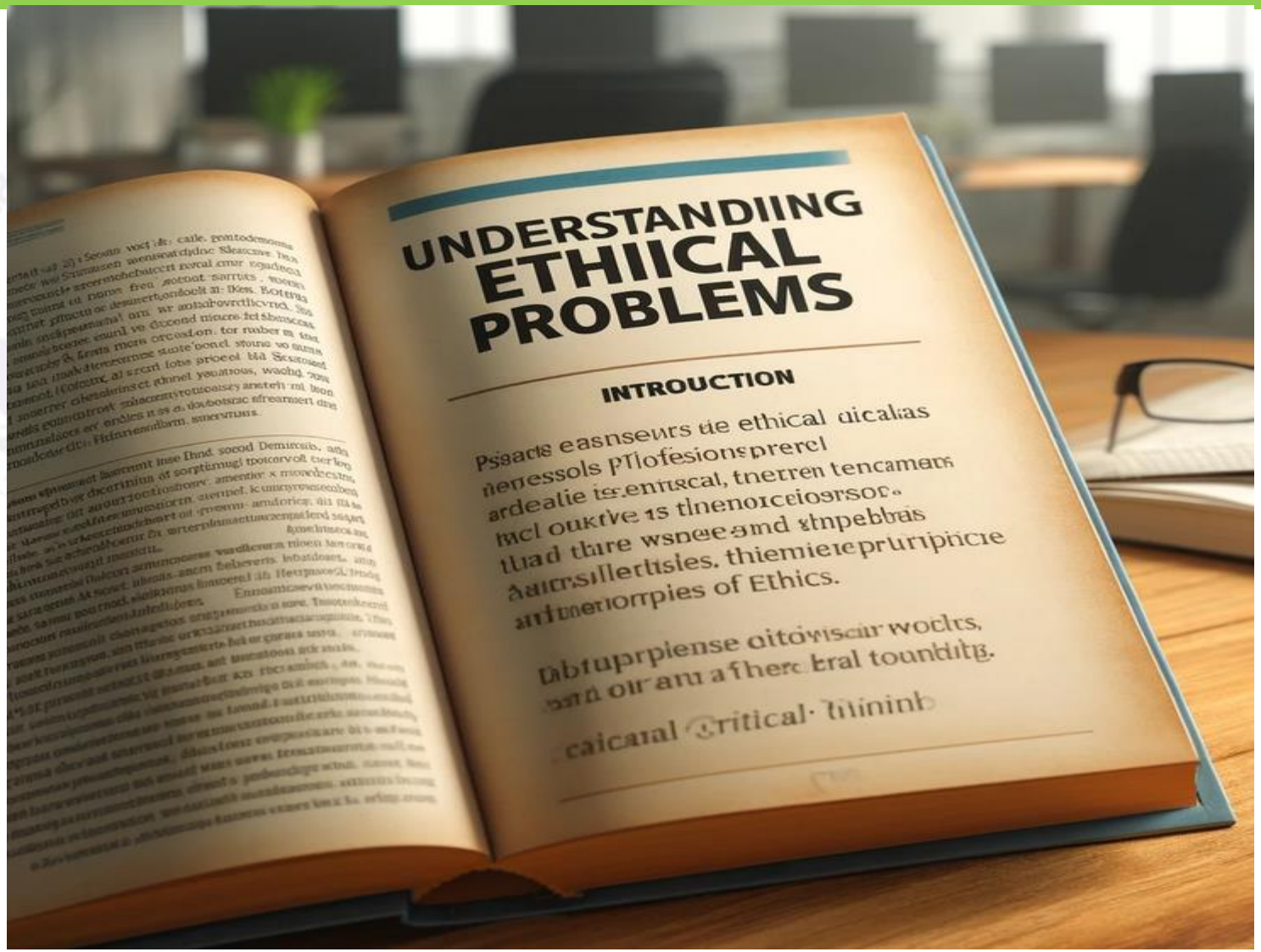
Learning Outcomes

In this Lecture will cover ..

- To Understand different perspectives on risk management:
- To Analyze the engineer's approach to risk:
- To Examine the public's approach to risk:
- To Explore the government regulator's approach to risk:
- To Integrate diverse approaches to enhance safety and compliance:

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Understanding Ethical Problems



Understanding Ethical Problems

❖ **Background:**

- A Moral Theory defines terms in uniform ways and links ideas and problems together in consistent ways [Harris, Pritchard, and Rabins, 2000].
- Scientific theories also organize ideas, define terms, and facilitate problem solving. So, will use moral theories in exactly the same way that engineering theories are used in other classes.

Understanding Ethical Problems

❖ **Background:**

- Moral theories that can be applied to the ethical problems confronted by engineers.
- Unfortunately, a thorough and in-depth discussion of all possible ethical theories is beyond the scope of this text.
- The moral and ethical theories that we will be applying in engineering ethics
- are derived from a Western cultural tradition. In other words, these ideas originated in the Middle East and Europe.

Understanding Ethical Problems

- **Four Ethical Theories:**
- Each ethical theory differing according to what is held to be the most important moral concept.
- Utilitarianism:
- Duty Ethics or Deontology:
- Rights Ethics or Ethics of Care:
- Virtue Ethics:

Understanding Ethical Problems

- **Four Ethical Theories:**
- **1. Utilitarianism:**
- **Define:** As a balance between good and bad consequences of an action, taking into account the consequences for everyone affected. **OR**
- Advocates for actions that maximize happiness or pleasure and minimize pain or suffering for the greatest number of people.
- It is consequentialist, meaning the moral value of an action is determined by its outcome.

Understanding Ethical Problems

- **Four Ethical Theories:**
- **1. Utilitarianism:**
- **Founder:** Jeremy Bentham and later expanded by John Stuart Mill.
- **Real World Application:** Utilitarianism is often used in decision-making processes where the impacts on the wider community are considered, such as in public policy and healthcare in government or private organizations.

Understanding Ethical Problems

- **Four Ethical Theories:**
- **2. Duty Ethics Or Deontology:**
- **Define:** To treat others fairly or the duty not to injure others) regardless of whether these acts lead to the best.
- It focuses on the morality of actions based on whether they adhere to a set of rules or duties, regardless of the consequences. It is often contrasted with consequentialist theories like utilitarianism because it prioritizes adherence to moral norms over the results of the action.

Understanding Ethical Problems

- **Four Ethical Theories:**
- **2. Duty Ethics Or Deontology:**
- **Founder:** Immanuel Kant is a prominent figure in formulating deontological ethics, especially through his categorical imperative, which dictates that actions must be universally applicable.
- **Real World Application:** Deontology is influential in fields that prioritize principles and rules, such as law and business ethics.

Understanding Ethical Problems

- **Four Ethical Theories:**
- **3. Virtue Ethics:**
- **Define:** It emphasizes the role of one's character and the virtues that shape it, rather than on following a set of rules or maximizing a particular outcome. This theory focuses on being rather than doing.
- **Historical Roots:** Aristotelian ethics, developed by Aristotle, is foundational to virtue ethics, emphasizing virtues like courage, temperance, and justice.

Understanding Ethical Problems

- **Four Ethical Theories:**
- **3. Virtue Ethics:**
- **Real World Application:** Virtue ethics is prevalent in personal development and educational contexts, where the emphasis is on cultivating good character traits over time.

Understanding Ethical Problems

- **Four Ethical Theories:**
- **4. Rights Ethics or Ethics of Care:**
- **Define:** It is a theory that emphasizes the importance of interpersonal relationships and care as a fundamental aspect of human life.
- It challenges the traditional ethical focus on justice, autonomy, and rights, advocating for a contextual and relational approach to ethical decision-making.

Understanding Ethical Problems

- **Four Ethical Theories:**
- **4. Rights Ethics or Ethics of Care:**
- **Founder:** Carol Gilligan and Nel Noddings are two key philosophers who have developed this theory, highlighting the role of empathy, compassion, and emotional commitments.
- **Real World Application:** It is particularly influential in fields like healthcare, education, and social work, where caregiving is central to the profession.

Ethical Problems: An Organization



Ethical Problems: An Organization

- **Background:**
- The systematic process by which an organization identifies, analyzes, and resolves ethical dilemmas in its operations. This involves several key components:
- Ethical Framework Establishment:
- Training and Awareness:
- Communication and Reporting Mechanisms:
- Ethical Decision-Making Tools:

Ethical Problems: An Organization

- **Ethical Framework Establishment:**
- The organization develops a comprehensive set of ethical guidelines and principles that define acceptable behaviors and decision-making processes.
- This framework should align with the organization's core values, mission, and the legal landscape within which it operates.

Ethical Problems: An Organization

- **Training and Awareness:**
- Regular training sessions are held to educate employees about the ethical standards and expectations.
- These sessions help in embedding an ethical mindset across all levels of the organization and ensure that everyone.
- To understands how to apply ethical principles in various situations.

Ethical Problems: An Organization

- **Communication and Reporting Mechanisms:**
- The organization promotes an open culture where employees can freely discuss ethical concerns and report unethical behavior without fear of retaliation.
- Mechanisms such as anonymous hotlines or digital platforms for reporting can be crucial in facilitating this transparency.

Ethical Problems: An Organization

- **Ethical Decision-Making Tools:**
- Tools and processes are put in place to aid employees in making ethical decisions. These might include decision-making frameworks that guide employees through ethical dilemmas, encouraging them.
- To consider all relevant factors and the potential impact of their decisions on all stakeholders.

Morally Responsible Organization without Getting Hurt

- **Background:**
- Being morally responsible in an organization often involves navigating complex situations while maintaining integrity and personal well-being.
- Here are ways to be morally responsible without getting hurt, illustrated with real-world examples:
- Use Established Channels for Reporting Issues:
- Seek Guidance from Ethics Advisors or Committees:
- Foster a Supportive Network:

Morally Responsible Organization without Getting Hurt

- **Background:**
- Use Established Channels for Reporting Issues:
- Seek Guidance from Ethics Advisors or Committees:
- Foster a Supportive Network:
- Document Everything:

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Morally Responsible Organization without Getting Hurt

- **Use Established Channels for Reporting Issues:**
- **Strategy:** Utilize the organization's established protocols for reporting unethical behavior or concerns. This includes hotlines, ombudsman services, or confidential reporting systems.
- **Real-World Example:** A major technology company encourages employees to report any unethical behavior through its internal reporting tool, which guarantees anonymity. This system has successfully resolved numerous cases of

Morally Responsible Organization without Getting Hurt

- **Use Established Channels for Reporting Issues:**
- **Real-World Example:** A major technology company encourages employees to report any unethical behavior through its internal reporting tool, which guarantees anonymity. This system has successfully resolved numerous cases of misconduct without exposing the identities of the whistleblowers.

Morally Responsible Organization without Getting Hurt

- **Seek Guidance from Ethics Advisors or Committees:**
- **Strategy:** Before taking action on complex ethical dilemmas, consult with ethics advisors or committees within the organization. They can provide guidance that aligns with both ethical standards and company policies.
- **Real-World Example:** A healthcare professional at a hospital faced an ethical dilemma about patient privacy. Instead of acting alone, she consulted the hospital's ethics committee, which

Morally Responsible Organization without Getting Hurt

- **Seek Guidance from Ethics Advisors or Committees:**
- **Real-World Example:** Instead of acting alone, she consulted the hospital's ethics committee, which provided clear guidance on how to handle the situation according to both legal and ethical standards.

Morally Responsible Organization without Getting Hurt

- **Foster a Supportive Network:**
- **Strategy:** Build relationships with colleagues who share a commitment to ethical practices. A supportive network can provide advice and backing when facing ethical challenges.
- **Real-World Example:** Employees at a financial firm formed an informal ethics discussion group.
- This group meets regularly to discuss ethical issues and supports members who face ethical dilemmas – Continue Next Page.

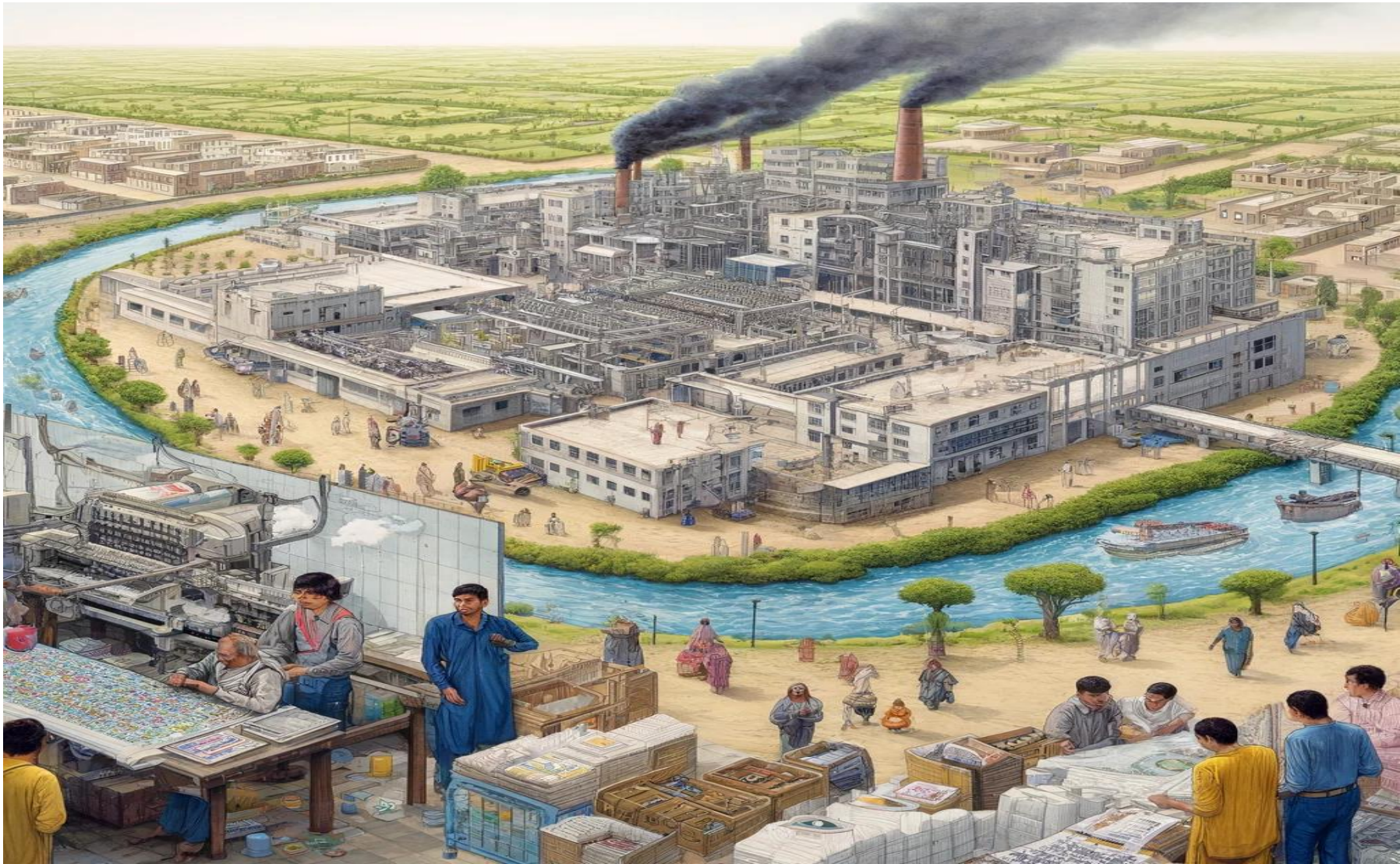
Morally Responsible Organization without Getting Hurt

- **Foster a Supportive Network:**
- **Real-World Example:** Providing a collective voice that can advocate for ethical decision-making without singling out individuals.
- **Document Everything:**
- **Strategy:** Keep detailed records of any incidents or decisions involving ethical considerations. Documentation can protect you if there are questions about your actions or if you face retaliation.

Morally Responsible Organization without Getting Hurt

- **Foster a Supportive Network:**
- **Real-World Example:** An engineer at a construction company noticed shortcuts being taken that compromised safety. She documented these practices and her communications with management.
- When regulatory inspectors investigated, her meticulous records demonstrated her commitment to safety and compliance, protecting her from potential backlash.

Case Study: Ethical Challenges in the Pakistani Textile Industry:



Case Study

- **Case Study: Ethical Challenges in the Pakistani Textile Industry:**
- **Background:** The textile industry is one of the largest sectors in Pakistan, significantly contributing to the country's economy, employing millions of people, and serving as a major export sector.
- Despite its economic importance, the industry faces numerous ethical challenges, particularly concerning labor practices, environmental impact, and corporate governance.

Case Study

- **Scenario:**
- A textile manufacturing company, "Zeenat Textiles," located in Lahore, Pakistan, has been under scrutiny for various ethical concerns. Despite professing adherence to international labor and environmental standards, reports have emerged alleging poor working conditions, underpayment, and violations of environmental regulations.

Case Study

- **Ethical Issues:**
- **Labor Practices:** Employees at Zeenat Textiles reportedly work long hours for wages below the legal minimum. The factory also employs underage workers in various production processes.
- **Environmental Impact:** The company has been accused of improperly disposing of chemical dyes and waste, leading to severe water pollution affecting the local communities and ecosystems.

Case Study

- **Ethical Issues:**
- **Transparency and Accountability:** There have been issues with transparency in reporting practices. Allegations suggest that the company has manipulated records to pass compliance audits.

Case Study

- **Ethical Analysis:** Using the framework of the major ethical theories:
- **Utilitarian Perspective:** From a utilitarian viewpoint, the company's practices are harmful as they prioritize profit over the well-being of workers and the environment. The greatest happiness principle is violated as the actions of the company result in harm to a larger segment of stakeholders, including employees, local communities, and the ecosystem.

Case Study

- **Ethical Analysis:** Using the framework of the major ethical theories:
- **Deontological Perspective:** According to deontological ethics, Zeenat Textiles is failing in its duty to act ethically towards its employees and the environment.
- The company's actions are not aligned with moral laws or rights, such as the right to fair wages, safe working conditions, and a clean environment.

Case Study

- **Virtue Ethics:** From the perspective of virtue ethics, the leadership at Zeenat Textiles lacks the virtues of fairness, integrity, and responsibility. These are crucial for fostering trust and moral excellence within the organization and its community.
- **Ethics of Care:** This approach would emphasize the relationships and responsibilities the company has towards its employees and the local community. The lack of care for employee welfare and environmental stewardship shows a failure in ethical responsibility.

Case Study

- **Solution and Recommendations:**
- To address these ethical issues, Zeenat Textiles should undertake the following steps:
- **Implement Strict Compliance:** Enforce strict adherence to labor laws, including wages, working hours, and underage labor. Compliance should be regularly monitored by independent auditors.
- **Environmental Management:** Invest in sustainable and eco-friendly technologies for waste management.

Case Study

- **Solution and Recommendations:**
- **Environmental Management:** Invest in sustainable and eco-friendly technologies for waste management. Ensure all practices meet national and international environmental standards.
- **Enhance Transparency:** Develop a transparent reporting system that allows stakeholders to access information about labor practices and environmental impacts.

Case Study

- **Solution and Recommendations:**
- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Engage with employees, local communities, and environmental groups to receive feedback and adjust practices accordingly.
- **Conclusion:**
- This case study highlights the complex ethical landscape in the Pakistani textile industry.
- By addressing these ethical concerns, Zeenat Textiles can not only improve its reputation but

– To be continue on next page.

Case Study

- **Conclusion:**
- This case study highlights the complex ethical landscape in the Pakistani textile industry.
- By addressing these ethical concerns, Zeenat Textiles can not only improve its reputation but also contribute positively to the economic and social fabric of Pakistan, setting a standard for ethical practices in the industry.

Thanks

Any Question

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